Personnel. Importance of the man behind the machine, as well as our veterans.
Quality. To stress on quality rather than quantity, especially in procurements.

The presser went off well, and subsequent reporting was quick to pick up on the nuances of my remarks on Allegiance to the Constitution of India. Veterans too were happy since they believed they were no longer being ignored. I had kept this close to my chest and even my Staff Officers were unaware of what I was going to say. The Army Day Parade was executed flawlessly. As the former GOC of Delhi Area, I quite knew what to expect. The At Home was an event by itself with over 400 guests, ranging from diplomats to service attachés, serving and retired officers from the three Services as well as CAPFs and journalists of all hues. For the first time after a long gap, both the President and the Prime Minister graced the occasion, along with Shri Rajnath Singh, the RM, and Shri Shripad Yesso Naik, the RRM. Dr Manmohan Singh and Ghulam Nabi Azad from the Opposition, Shri SA Bobde, Chief Justice of India, Shri Ajit Doval, NSA and, of course, Gen Bipin Rawat, the CDS, and Air Chief Marshal RKS Bhadauria, the CAS. Veena and I were there to receive all the guests. As soon as the PM alighted, he remarked jokingly to Veena, '*Aap mere ghar daawat par nahin aye*' (You didn't come to my residence for dinner). We were both quite taken aback that he had remembered such a small incident and promised that next time we would both be there. As part of this event, it is customary to screen a short documentary highlighting the past year's achievements. This too we did differently by preparing a short cameo, with the theme 'Indian Army—Invisible but Everywhere'. It had no narration, just stunning visuals of Army operations in different terrains.

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